IBDP Year 1 | Artificial Intelligence

Designing a Mindful Work App for Stress-Free Offices

A Design Thinking Project

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FRAMEWORK

Design Thinking Process

1
Empathize
Understand users' needs & emotions

2
Define
Frame the core problem

3
Ideate
Generate creative solutions

4
Prototype
Build a rough solution

5
Test
Evaluate & refine

OVERVIEW

Project Overview

Objective

Design an AI-powered stress relief app
Personalized relaxation: music, meditation, sensory environments
Help employees manage workplace stress effectively

Research Questions

What triggers stress in modern workplaces?
Which coping methods are most effective?
How can AI personalize stress relief?
Are users open to AI-based solutions?

Expected Outcomes

Identify key stress patterns
Map user needs to app features
Develop evidence-based personas
Define an actionable problem statement

EMPATHIZE

Research Methodology

Tool Used

Google Form survey distributed to professionals and students across industries

Respondents

7 participants from diverse roles: IT, Management, Creative, Interns & Students

Topics Covered

Stress levels, triggers, emotions, coping methods, preferred features, AI comfort

Primary research | April 2025 | Google Forms Platform

DATA SOURCES

Research Access & Data Sources

Google Form Survey

Link: [Google Form – Placeholder URL]

Primary survey instrument

Response Data Sheet

Link: [Google Sheets – Placeholder URL]

Raw data from all respondents

Research Note

Primary research was conducted using a structured Google Form distributed to 7 respondents across IT, Management, Creative, and student roles. The survey captured stress levels (1–5 scale), key triggers, emotional states, coping methods, preferred app features, and comfort with AI-based stress detection.

EMPATHIZE

Key Research Insights

High Stress Levels

Most respondents rate stress 3–5 out of 5 — moderate to very high

Top Stress Triggers

Deadlines, heavy workloads & back-to-back meetings dominate

Dominant Emotions

Anxious, overwhelmed & tired are the most reported states

Ineffective Coping

Existing methods score only 1–3 / 5 in effectiveness

Demand for Personalization

Strong interest in custom relaxation: music, meditation, lighting

Mixed AI Comfort

4 of 7 open to AI detection; others prefer manual control

R

Persona 1 of 7

The Overloaded Tech Professional

Name: Riya

Age: 23–30

Role: IT / Tech Specialist

Env.: Office

Stress: 4 / 5

"I have too much to finish in less time."

Goals

- Consistent, calming breaks during afternoons
- Dim-light quiet space to decompress
- Reduce screen fatigue with audio relaxation

Frustrations

- Breaks are neither consistent nor effective
- Deadline pressure prevents proper rest
- Screen overload causes anxiety & fatigue

Needs

- Music-based stress relief
- AI mood detection to trigger breaks
- Stress-level tracking over time

A

Persona 2 of 7

The Perfectionist Manager

Name: Aarav

Age: 31–40

Role: Manager

Env.: Office

Stress: 5 / 5

"I need everything to go perfectly."

Goals

- Quick guided meditation between meetings
- Structured relaxation schedule
- Mood-based break recommendations

Frustrations

- No time carved out to relax
- Back-to-back meetings cause constant anxiety
- High expectations raise internal pressure

Needs

- Silent guided meditation sessions
- Break booking / scheduling feature
- AI mood detection reminders

P

Persona 3 of 7

The Exhausted Intern

Name: Priya

Age: 18–22

Role: Intern

Env.: Hybrid

Stress: 3 / 5

"I feel exhausted and distracted."

Goals

- Evening wind-down routine with visuals & music
- Reduce phone-based distractions
- Nature sounds for focus & calm

Frustrations

- Phone use as coping makes distraction worse
- Heavy workload with few planned breaks
- Evening burnout affects next-day performance

Needs

- Visual + music relaxation environment
- Nature sound library
- Guided break reminders

S

Persona 4 of 7

The Overworked Senior

Name: Sameer

Age: 40+

Role: Senior Manager

Env.: Office

Stress: 4 / 5

"There's too much responsibility."

Goals

- Complete silence during afternoon reset
- Structured system for daily relaxation
- Stress-tracking without AI intrusion

Frustrations

- No existing system or routine for relaxation
- Meetings and responsibility pile on
- Overwhelmed with no outlet — effectiveness: 1/5

Needs

- Silent environment mode
- Manual stress log / tracking dashboard
- Non-AI feature options (privacy preference)

A

Persona 5 of 7

The Late-Night Creative

Name: Ananya

Age: 23–30

Role: Creative Professional

Env.: WFH

Stress: 3 / 5

"I can't focus anymore."

Goals

- Soft-lit + music environment at late hours
- Easy way to disconnect from screen work
- Mood detection for late-night focus dips

Frustrations

- Hard to mentally disconnect after WFH hours blur
- Screen fatigue mixed with deadline anxiety
- Breaks don't feel restorative enough

Needs

- Ambient soft lighting + music combo
- AI mood check-ins
- Curated relaxation playlists

R

Persona 6 of 7

The Pressure-Driven Developer

Name: Rahul

Age: 23–30

Role: IT / Developer

Env.: Hybrid

Stress: 5 / 5

"I'm constantly under pressure."

Goals

- Guided breathing exercises for evening relief
- Dashboard to see stress patterns
- Consistent breaks that actually work

Frustrations

- Current breaks and social media don't help — 2/5
- Noise in hybrid office amplifies pressure
- Constant deadlines with no breathing room

Needs

- Guided breathing / breathwork feature
- Stress dashboard & analytics
- Meditation module for deep decompression

N

Persona 7 of 7

The Mildly Drained Student

Name: Neha

Age: 18–22

Role: Student

Env.: WFH

Stress: 2 / 5

"I just need a small break."

Goals

- Simple music-based micro-breaks
- Lightweight app that doesn't feel demanding
- Evening relaxation with favourite songs

Frustrations

- Mild but persistent tiredness accumulates
- Lack of planned breaks during study sessions
- No dedicated tool for light-touch relaxation

Needs

- Music relaxation environment
- Calming visual + audio combinations
- Quick-launch break mode

DEFINE

Insight Clusters

Stress Triggers

- Deadlines & overwork
- Back-to-back meetings
- Screen fatigue & noise
- Lack of structured breaks

Emotional Patterns

- Anxious & overwhelmed
- Exhausted & unmotivated
- Frustrated & under pressure
- Evening burnout common

Ineffective Coping

- Phone / social media usage
- Random, inconsistent breaks
- No system in place
- Average effectiveness: 2.5/5

User Needs

- Personalized relaxation modes
- AI-driven mood detection
- Guided meditation & breathing
- Quiet spaces + ambient sound

DEFINE

Problem Statements — Point of View

Aarav — Perfectionist Manager

Aarav is a high-stress manager who needs a structured, silent meditation system integrated into his work schedule because back-to-back meetings and perfectionism leave him with no time or system for relaxation.

Riya — Tech Professional

Riya is an anxious IT professional who needs consistent, AI-triggered break reminders with music and dim-light environments because her breaks are currently random, ineffective, and ignored under deadline pressure.

Rahul — Pressure-Driven Developer

Rahul is a highly stressed developer who needs guided breathing and a visual stress-tracking dashboard because social media and random breaks aren't reducing his constant sense of workplace pressure.

IDEATE

How Might We…

01

How Might We…

HMW help employees take consistent, effective breaks without disrupting their workflow?

02

How Might We…

HMW use AI to detect stress in real-time and automatically recommend a personalized relaxation experience?

03

How Might We…

HMW design a sensory relaxation environment (sound + light + visuals) that adapts to individual user preferences?

04

How Might We…

HMW give employees a clear picture of their own stress patterns so they can proactively manage wellbeing?

DEFINE

User Journey Map

Stage	Stress Level	Pain Point	App Opportunity
Start Work	**Low → Mid**	Morning pressure begins — deadlines visible	Morning mood check-in + gentle reminders
During Work	**High**	Workload peaks; meetings drain energy	AI detects stress spike → suggests break
Break Time	**Mid → Low**	Breaks are skipped or ineffective	Guided session: music / meditation / breathing
After Work	**Residual**	Hard to disconnect; late-night fatigue	Evening wind-down: ambient sound + soft light

CONCLUSION

Key Takeaways

01

Stress is frequent & poorly managed — 6 of 7 respondents rate stress 3+/5 with ineffective relief strategies

02

Existing coping methods are inadequate — average effectiveness is only 2.7/5 across all respondents

03

Users want personalization — music, meditation, ambient environments tailored to their mood and role

04

AI can meaningfully improve relaxation — 4 of 7 are open to AI detection; app must offer opt-out too

REFERENCES

References & Tools Used

Canva

Visual design platform — used for design inspiration and layout mockups

https://www.canva.com

ChatGPT

AI language model by OpenAI — used for research ideation and content drafting

https://chat.openai.com

Claude

AI assistant by Anthropic — used for persona development and structured analysis

https://claude.ai

Google Forms

Survey tool — used to collect primary data from 7 respondents

https://forms.google.com

Thank You

Designing for wellbeing — one mindful break at a time.

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